happen, China is taking concrete steps to strengthen cooperation and security dialogue with other like-minded nations. Thus, other parties in the initiative jointly formulated a code of conduct for regional security and the Asian security partnership program (Ministry of Foreign Affairs of the People's Republic of China 2014).

At the same meeting mentioned above, Jinping (2014) stressed that China was ready to discuss with regional nations to create an Asian forum for security cooperation. It would help respond to its major security emergencies by coordinating national efforts in the region. In 2014, during the Brisbane G-20 summit, when Russia was isolated from the meeting, the BRICS foreign ministers came forward to give a communiqué that Russia should not be excluded from the G-20 Summit. China wanted a peaceful solution to the Ukraine crisis and helped Russia stabilize its economy (Stuenkel 2015; Haibin 2015). Similarly, when the United Nations General Assembly voted in resolution no. 68/262 on March 27, 2014, by condemning the Russian policy on the Ukraine crisis, China, India, South Africa, and Brazil abstained from voting. China's permanent representative to the UN, Liu Jieyi, condemned international interference in Russia's internal affairs (United Nations 2014). Russia and China are together when the situation arises.

When Russia intervened in the Ukraine crisis, no BRICS policymaker criticized the Russian act; however, they called for a peaceful resolution. Furthermore, India, China, South Africa, and Brazil, including 54 other countries, abstained from voting on the UN General Assembly resolution on the Crimean referendum and criticized it (Stuenkel 2015). All of these instances imply that BRICS countries are together, no matter what attempt the West makes to reduce the status of its member countries, and that BRICS will come together in unity. While responding to the media over whether anti-Russian international sanctions imposed by the Western world could hamper trade and commerce ties between China and Russia, the Chinese minister Zhang Jun (2015, at the Ufa summit) said:

> Unilateral sanctions imposed against Russia do not apply to BRICS members. (Sputnik International 2015)

Furthermore, the West deployed R2P[4] to justify its claim on Crimea, potentially a part of Eastern Ukraine. It threatened its Russian 'compatriots'